SeroTix

Product & Brand Rationale

WHY IT'S BUILT THIS WAY

August 2026

01 — MARKET CONTEXT

What SeroTix is actually competing with

> Ten days before this document was written, Ticketmaster entered Kenya for the first time — through a partnership with Quicket — bringing global scale and distribution through Spotify, Google, and Meta. It also brings real baggage: the 2022 Taylor Swift ticketing failure, a 2024 DOJ antitrust suit, and an April 2026 conviction on monopolization charges.

But the more important finding from research is this: **most Kenyan events aren't sold on any platform at all.** The default is a Till number pasted into an Instagram caption, with payment proof collected as WhatsApp screenshots and matched by hand.

Tier	Who	Reality
Direct	Tikiti, LipaTix, TicketBlaze	All M-Pesa-native already — table stakes locally, not a differentiator on their own.
Adjacent / global	Ticketmaster/Quicket, Eventbrite, Pesapal Events, Ticketsasa	Eventbrite has zero M-Pesa support. Pesapal and Ticketsasa are reviewed as dated and clunky.
Status quo	Till number + WhatsApp screenshots, Google Forms + Till	**This is where most organizers actually are.** Rated 1.5/5 and 2/5 in independent comparisons — fake screenshots, manual reconciliation, zero

number gate control.

Positioning

> For Kenyan event organizers stuck between clunky global platforms and Till-number/WhatsApp chaos — and the fans who buy from them — SeroTix gets an organizer from zero to a real, fraud-proof QR-ticketed event in minutes, and a buyer from browsing to a ticket on their phone in under a minute. Unlike Ticketmaster/Quicket, it carries no monopoly baggage. Unlike the status quo, every ticket is validated once, automatically, at the door.

Sources: KenyanVibe (Ticketmaster/Quicket analysis), LipaTix (platform comparison), both retrieved August 2026.

02 — BRAND, IN BRIEF

The identity carries the positioning

Name: SeroTix — short, phonetic, the "Tix" suffix reads as ticketing without needing explanation.

Mark: a literal ticket glyph — perforated stub, tear-line — not an abstract monogram. It has to read as "a real ticket" even at favicon size, because looking legitimate is the whole point when the alternative is a stranger's Till number.

Color: violet as the one brand accent, used flatly — never as a decorative gradient. Deep crimson is reserved specifically for urgency and scarcity (sold out, low stock) — it's functional, not decorative. Category colors (concert, festival, nightlife, etc.) are fixed and consistent everywhere they appear, so they carry real information when someone is scanning a list of events, not just decoration.

Voice: direct, energetic, never corporate. "Doors open in 3 days" beats "Please be advised." Confidence doesn't need exclamation marks.

Full color values, logo usage rules, and type specification are in the companion document, SeroTix_Brand_Guidelines.pdf.

03 — WHY EVERY COMPONENT EXISTS

The buyer-facing product

Rich event pages — photo gallery, lineup/schedule, "Get Directions"

Why it matters

A Till number in an Instagram caption has no way to look legitimate. A page with real photos, a named lineup, and a one-tap directions link does — it's the single biggest lever against "is this even real?" hesitation, which is the actual objection SeroTix is competing against, not a competitor's feature list.

M-Pesa STK Push checkout (native, not manual till-number matching)

Why it matters

Every serious alternative in this market already does M-Pesa — it's the entry ticket, not the differentiator. What matters is that it's *automatic*: the buyer gets a prompt on their phone, confirms with their PIN, and the order is marked paid by Safaricom's own callback — no screenshot, no manual matching, none of the fraud vector that makes the status quo a 1.5/5 experience.

One QR code per ticket, single-use, server-validated

Why it matters

This is the actual fraud-proofing mechanism, and it's the thing a screenshot fundamentally cannot do: a screenshot can be shown to five different door staff, but a QR code that's marked "used" the instant it's scanned can't be. This one property is what separates "we take M-Pesa" from "we solved the actual problem."

"Why not just use a Till number?" comparison on the homepage

Why it matters

The fraud/reconciliation pain is real and independently rated — but nobody selling against the status quo says it out loud. Naming the alternative directly, with a specific comparison, turns a vague "trust us" pitch into a concrete, checkable claim.

03 — WHY EVERY COMPONENT EXISTS (CONTINUED)

The organizer-facing product

Self-serve organizer dashboard (/manage/) — events, pricing, gallery, lineup

Why it matters

The real addressable market isn't organizers choosing between ticketing platforms — it's organizers currently using nothing formal at all. A competitor markets "5-minute setup" as a headline feature for exactly this reason: onboarding friction is existential when the alternative is "just post a Till number," which has zero setup friction by definition.

Camera-based door scanner — continuous scan, not one ticket per page load

Why it matters

"Zero gate control" is a named, specific weakness of the status quo in independent research. A QR ticket that nobody actually scans at speed doesn't solve that. The scanner is built for a real door: point the camera, get an instant checked-in / already-used / not-found result, and the camera stays open for the next person — because a busy door can't afford a full page reload per guest.

Django admin + a separate branded dashboard, not one or the other

Why it matters

Django's built-in admin is genuinely excellent for data management and cost nothing extra to wire up — used for anything an operator, not an organizer, needs to see (orders, payments, raw records). The custom dashboard exists specifically for the day-to-day organizer workflow (events, pricing, photos, lineup) where a generic admin table would feel like exactly the kind of clunky, dated interface the research flags in competitors.

03 — WHY EVERY COMPONENT EXISTS (CONTINUED)

Infrastructure decisions

schema.org Event structured data + OpenGraph tags + sitemap.xml

Why it matters

Eventbrite reported traffic to event listing pages roughly doubling after implementing this kind of structured data — it's how an event shows up with a date, price, and venue directly in a Google search result, and how a shared link on WhatsApp shows a real preview card instead of a bare URL. Both matter more in a market where WhatsApp groups are already a primary discovery channel.

Self-hosted CSS and JavaScript — no external CDN dependency at runtime

Why it matters

This was learned the hard way during development: a CDN-loaded CSS framework silently failed to apply in a real browser test, and a hand-typed integrity hash on a CDN script silently blocked the entire interactive layer of the site — both without a visible error to the user, just a broken page. Every asset the product depends on to function now ships from its own server. That is a reliability property, not an aesthetic one, and it matters more on the variable connections common outside major towns.

Flat, functional color system instead of decorative gradients

Why it matters

A soft purple-to-orange gradient with glassmorphism cards is the specific visual pattern that makes an AI-built product look like every other AI-built product. Flat color used with intent — one brand accent, one urgency color, fixed category colors that carry real information — is what makes the product look considered rather than templated.

04 — OPEN QUESTIONS, HONESTLY

What isn't built yet

> Research surfaced one clear gap not yet addressed: referral and promo-code tooling. One cited industry figure claims roughly 20:1 ROI on built-in referral programs — plausible given how much of this market already moves through WhatsApp groups and word of mouth, but not yet verified against SeroTix's own data because the feature doesn't exist yet.

- Promo / discount codes at checkout — not built.
- Referral tracking and attribution — not built.
- Organizer-side sales analytics beyond the dashboard's basic sold/revenue counts — not built.
- User accounts for buyers (currently guest checkout with order-reference lookup) — a deliberate choice so far, not an oversight: it removes a signup step from the buying flow, at the cost of no saved order history across visits.